

Dharma Events

User Testing Guide

A step-by-step walkthrough for testing event registration, invitations, and QR check-in.

What's covered:

- Logging in
- Creating an event, categories, and invite PDF attachments
- Adding registrations (manual entry and bulk Excel/CSV import) with mobile number and optional volunteer link
- Generating and sending invitation emails, including per-guest QR codes
- Scanning QR codes and checking in attendees at the venue
- Viewing the live dashboard and reports
- Common issues and how to resolve them

1. Logging In

Open the app in your browser using the address your administrator gave you (<https://events.sansmi.org>). You'll land on the sign-in screen.

- 1 Enter your email address and password.
- 2 Click **Sign in**.
- 3 You'll be redirected to the **Events** list.

If you don't have login credentials yet, ask your administrator to create an account for you.

2. Creating an Event

From the Events page:

- 1 Fill in **Event code** (a short unique identifier), **Event name**, and **Event date**.
- 2 Click **Create event**. It will appear in the events table with status *DRAFT*.
- 3 Click the event name to open its detail page.

On the Event Detail page you can:

- Toggle **Registration open** and **Check-in open** switches.
- Change the event **Status** (Draft → Active → Completed → Archived).
- Add one or more **Categories** (e.g. "General", "VIP", "Volunteer") — do this before adding registrations, since every registration must belong to a category.

Set status to **Active** and turn on both toggles before testing registration and check-in.

2b. Adding an Invite PDF Attachment (Optional)

You can attach a PDF (e.g. a formal invitation letter, event brochure, or map) that will be merged into the ticket email sent to guests, after their QR ticket pages.

- 1 On the Event Detail page, find the **Invite Attachment PDF** card and click **Upload** to choose a PDF (max 15 MB). This becomes the event's *common* template, used for every category that doesn't have its own.
- 2 Optionally, open each **Category** row and upload a PDF specific to that category (e.g. a different letter for VIP vs General guests). If a category has its own template, it is used instead of the event's common one for guests in that category.
- 3 Use **View** to double-check the uploaded PDF, or **Remove** to delete it.

Priority when an invitation is sent: the guest's **category template** is used if set, otherwise the **event's common template**, otherwise no attachment is added.

3. Adding Registrations

Option A — Add one at a time

Go to the event's **Registrations** tab and use the "Add Registration" form: name, email, mobile number (with country code), number of attendees, category, and — optionally — a linked **Volunteer** if a volunteer is escorting or sponsoring this guest.

If a volunteer is linked and your administrator has enabled it, that volunteer will also receive a copy (CC) of the guest's invitation email.

Option B — Bulk import from Excel/CSV

Use the "Import (.xlsx / .csv)" section to upload a spreadsheet of many registrations at once.

- 1 Click **Download blank template** to get a ready-made spreadsheet with the correct column headers, one filled example row, and one blank row to copy from — the easiest way to get the format right.
- 2 Fill in your rows (or prepare your own file with the column headers listed in the table below as the first row).
- 3 Click **Preview** and choose your file. The app shows how many rows are Valid, have Warnings, or have Errors, and lists the reason for each problem row.
- 4 Click **Import valid rows** to commit — rows with errors are skipped automatically (Warning rows are still imported).

Create all needed categories on the event *before* importing — unknown category names will cause a row to error out.

Excel/CSV Column Format

Column Header	Required?	Notes
Participant Name (or Name / Full Name)	Required	Row rejected if blank
Email (or Email Address)	Required	Must be a valid email format
WhatsApp / Mobile Number (or Mobile / Phone)	Optional	Warning only if malformed
No. of Attendees (or Number of Attendees)	Required	Positive whole number
Category	Required	Must exactly match (case-insensitive) an existing category name for that event
Timestamp (or Registered At)	Optional	Any parseable date; used as original registration time
Volunteer Name	Optional	Only if this row is a volunteer-escorted registration
Volunteer Email	Optional	Must be valid email if present

Example row: 2026-01-15 10:30 | Jane Doe | jane@example.com | +91 98765 43210 | 2 | General

4. Generating and Sending Invitations

Go to the event's **Invitations** tab. There are two steps:

- 1 **Generate Invitations** — creates a PDF ticket with a unique QR code for each registration and moves its status from Pending to Ready.
- 2 **Send All Ready** — actually emails the invitation to each participant via SMTP, moving status from Ready to Sent. This also happens automatically in the background every so often.

You can click **Preview PDF** next to any row to see the ticket before it's sent, and **Resend** to re-trigger delivery for one registration. The status column shows Not Sent / Pending / Sent / Failed for each registration.

If a registration has more than one attendee (e.g. "4 pax"), the ticket PDF will contain one page per guest, each with its own QR code labeled "Guest 1 of 4", "Guest 2 of 4", etc. — so each arriving guest can be scanned in individually at check-in.

If invitations stay stuck on "Pending" and never reach "Sent", ask your administrator to check that SMTP email settings have been configured on the server.

5. Scanning QR Codes at the Venue (Check-in)

Open the event's **Scanner** tab on a phone or tablet at the entrance.

- 1 Tap **SCAN QR** — the browser will ask for camera permission; allow it.
- 2 Point the camera at the participant's QR code (from their emailed ticket or printed pass). If a group registered together, each guest has their own QR page/code — scan each one as that person arrives.
- 3 The app shows the registration details, remaining headcount, and lets you confirm how many people are arriving right now before tapping **CHECK IN**.
- 4 If someone tries to check in again after their full party already arrived, a supervisor can use the **Override** option with a reason.
- 5 No camera? Use the **Search Participant** box to find someone by name, phone, or registration number and open their record manually.

Camera-based scanning only works when the site is loaded over **HTTPS** (or on "localhost"). If the app is only reachable over plain HTTP instead of `https://events.sansmi.org`, the browser will block camera access and "SCAN QR" will fail — use the manual Search box instead until HTTPS is set up by your administrator.

6. Dashboard and Reports

The event's **Dashboard** tab (visible to Supervisors and above) shows live counts: total registered, arrived, remaining, attendance percentage, a breakdown by category and by volunteer, an arrival timeline chart, and a feed of recent check-ins. It refreshes automatically every few seconds.

At the bottom, you can download **CSV** or **XLSX** reports for Attendance, No-shows, Check-in transactions, and Invitation delivery.

7. Troubleshooting Quick Reference

Login seems to work but the next action says "must be logged in"

The connection isn't secure (plain HTTP) so the session cookie isn't being saved. Ask your admin to check the server's HTTPS setup.

Category dropdown is empty when adding a registration

No categories exist yet for this event. Go to the Event Detail page and add at least one category first.

QR scanner won't turn on / camera permission fails

The site needs HTTPS (or localhost) for camera access. Use manual Search as a workaround, or ask your admin about HTTPS.

Invitations stuck on "Pending", never "Sent"

Email (SMTP) delivery isn't configured yet on the server — ask your administrator.

Import shows rows with errors

Open the preview list — each error row states the exact problem (e.g. missing name, invalid email, unknown category). Fix the spreadsheet and re-upload.

A fake or non-existent email shows as "Sent" instead of "Failed"

The app only marks an invitation "Failed" if the mail server rejects it immediately (e.g. malformed address). A well-formed but non-existent mailbox that the receiving server accepts and only bounces later cannot currently be distinguished from a real delivery — this would need extra bounce-tracking infrastructure.

Clicking a Reports CSV/XLSX link, or a PDF View/Preview link, goes back to the home page instead of opening the file

This was a caching bug in the installed app (PWA) and has been fixed. If you still see it, unregister the app's service worker and hard-refresh the browser: DevTools → Application tab → Service Workers → Unregister, then Application → Storage → Clear site data, then fully close and reopen the tab.

Navigation Tip

Registrations, Invitations, Scanner, and Dashboard each open as their own page. Use the ◀ **Back to Event** link at the top of each of these pages to return to the Event Detail page.